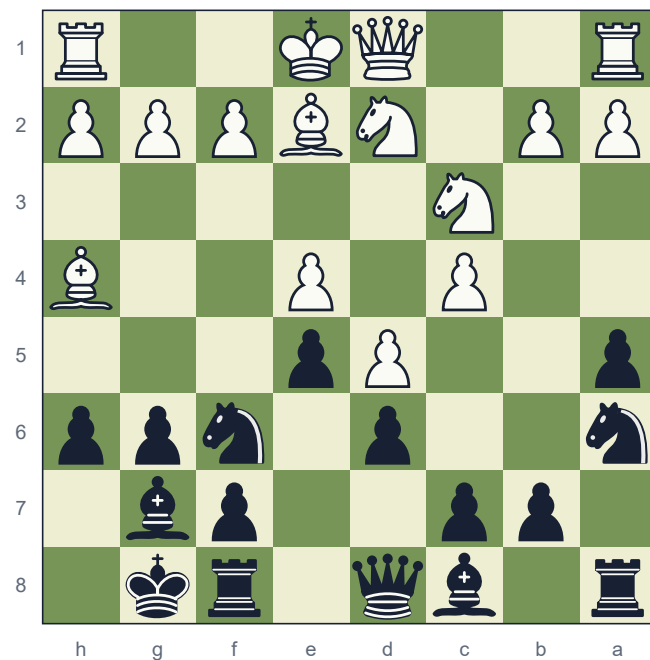


Petrosian Variation - 7.d5 before castling

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 h6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...a5 to restrain b4 before developing the b8 knight. White has closed the center without committing the king, so your kingside plan must stay flexible.



Main study anchor - Black to move

READ THE CENTER

The locked center resembles the Classical, but Black has not put the b8 knight on c6 and White can still choose Bg5, Be3 or h3.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Keep the b8 knight flexible.
2. Ask whether White has committed the king.
3. Treat Bg5 as a real restraint on ...f5.

Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Bg5 and queenside development

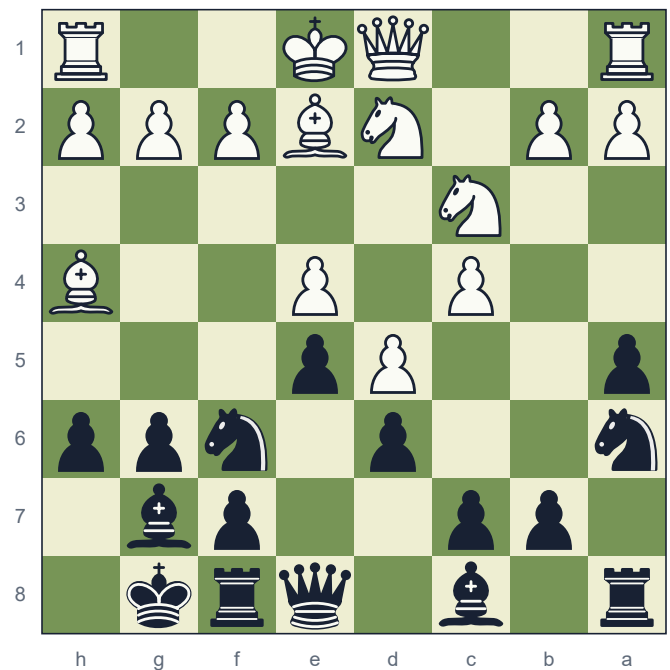
STUDY LINE 07-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 Na6 10. Nd2 Qe8

Selected anchor ends with 10. Nd2. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a5 restrains b4; ...Na6 offers c5 without blocking the c-pawn. ...h6 asks the bishop to declare its square.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Support ...Nc5 and consider ...Qe8 or ...Bd7 before forcing kingside expansion. Resolve the pin when it actually matters.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A quick ...g5 may give White h4 with an immediate target. Do not weaken the king just to imitate another line.

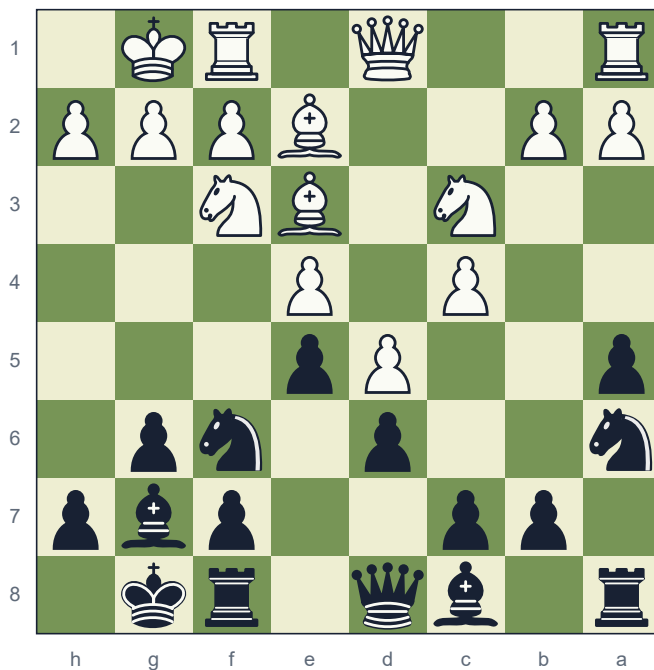
REMEMBER Flexibility comes from the knight and c-pawn.

02 White castles quietly

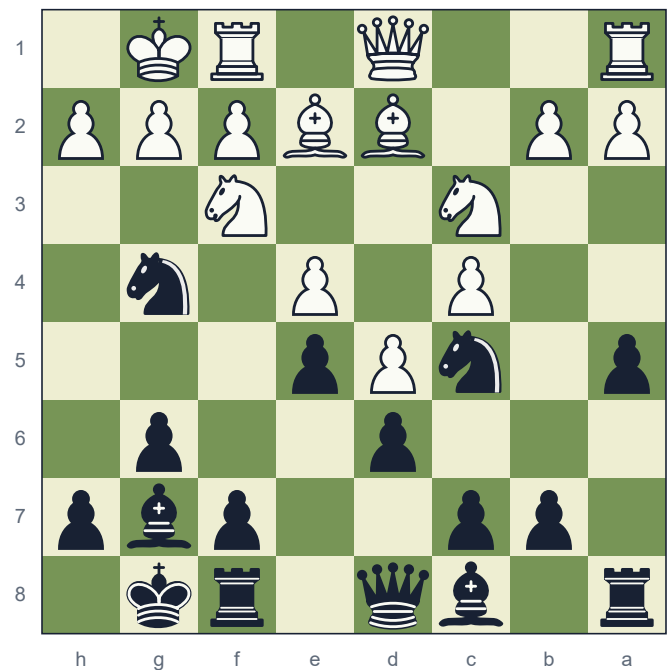
STUDY LINE 07-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. O-O Na6 9. Be3 Ng4 10. Bd2 Nc5

Selected anchor ends with 10. Bd2. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White's castling clarifies the king position. ...Ng4 questions Be3 while Na6 prepares a queenside route.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Choose ...f5 only after relocating the knight and securing e5. White still threatens queenside expansion.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Moving the same knight repeatedly must earn a concrete benefit, such as gaining the bishop pair or arranging a break.

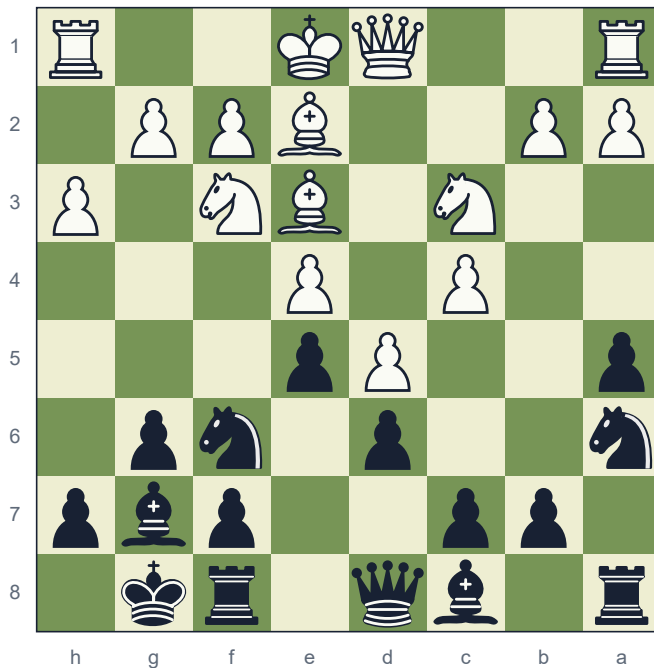
REMEMBER A tempo on a bishop can improve the whole setup.

03 White prevents the pin with h3

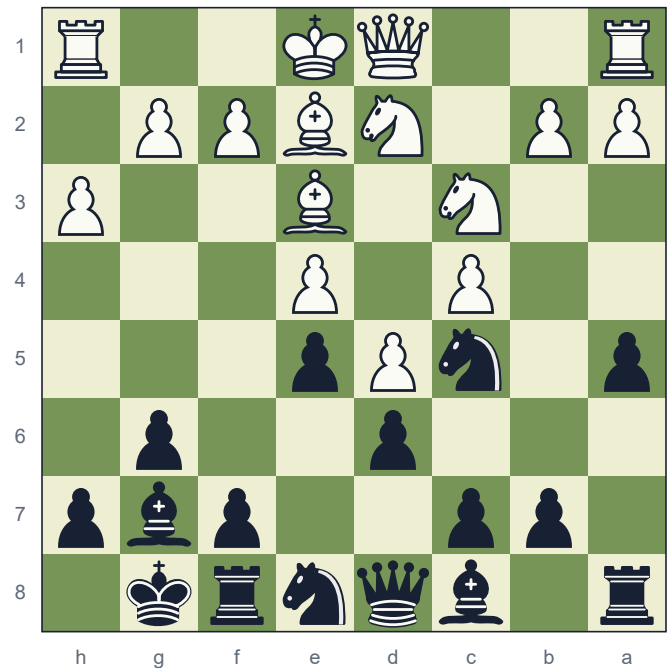
STUDY LINE 07-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. h3 Na6 9. Be3 Nc5 10. Nd2 Ne8

Selected anchor ends with 10. Nd2. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

h3 prevents ...Bg4 and restricts ...Ng4. Black seeks activity with ...Na6-c5 instead.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Ne8 and ...f5 if the center and king safety permit; first decide how to meet a3 and b4 against the c5 knight.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A knight on c5 can be chased. Make sure retreat squares remain and e5 stays defended.

REMEMBER A good outpost still needs a retreat plan.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The locked center resembles the Classical, but Black has not put the b8 knight on c6 and White can still choose Bg5, Be3 or h3.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Support ...Nc5 and consider ...Qe8 or ...Bd7 before forcing kingside expansion. Resolve the pin when it actually matters.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.